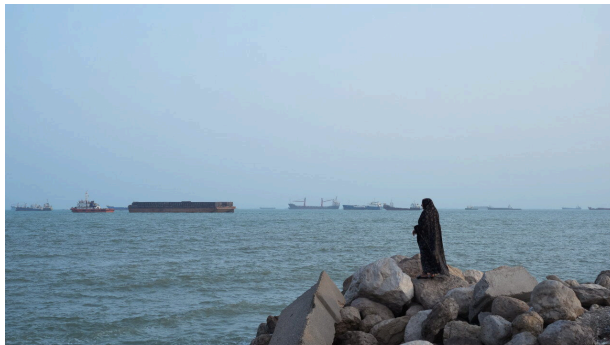


World in Brief: Trump threatens to bomb Oman; Jared Kushner meets Netanyahu



Photograph: Getty Images

Donald Trump threatened to bomb **Oman** if it “gets in the way” of America’s talks with **Iran** about reopening the [Strait of Hormuz](#), according to Fox News. Agreement would be one component of a peace deal. America is not involved in a parallel discussion between Oman and Iran about allowing more traffic through the waterway. A fragile 60-day truce between America and Iran expired on Monday.

Jared Kushner, Mr Trump’s son-in-law and one of his top envoys, met **Binyamin Netanyahu** in Jerusalem. Israel’s prime minister rejected America’s 15-point ceasefire plan for Gaza earlier this month. Mr Netanyahu’s office said the talks were “constructive”, and that two “working groups”, on disarmament of Gaza and public health in the territory, would be created. Mr Kushner met Hamas leaders in [Egypt](#) on Sunday.

Nvidia agreed to guarantee up to \$105bn worth of lease payments by OpenAI, a leading AI lab, for use of an **Ohio data centre** being built by SB Energy. The chipmaker also pledged to invest \$1.5bn in SB Energy, which is backed by SoftBank, a Japanese tech-investment firm. Although designed to generate demand for its chips, Nvidia denied the arrangement represented circular financing.

Andy Burnham, Britain's [prime minister](#), exchanged text messages with someone impersonating Mr Trump's chief of staff, Susie Wiles, compromising security, *Politico* reported. While officials insist no sensitive information was conveyed, the British embassy reportedly raised concerns with the White House, which declined to comment. Downing Street said it does not comment on "national security matters".

Taiwan's president, Lai Ching-te, announced that the cabinet's budget proposal for next year will include cash handouts of NT\$10,000 (\$314). The plan intends to share the economic gains from the country's semiconductor industry, which has delivered a major windfall for public coffers. Last week Taiwan's statistics bureau raised its annual growth forecast to 11.1%, which would be its highest rate in nearly four decades.

America's **Motion Picture Association** said it reached an intellectual-property agreement with **ByteDance**, the Chinese company behind TikTok, to "maintain strong guardrails" on AI-generated content. It did not describe them. In February the MPA [accused ByteDance of copyright infringement](#) after a user, with help from the company's Seedance 2.0 model, generated a video showing actors Tom Cruise and Brad Pitt fighting on a rooftop.

Ferrari sold a one-off version of the **Luce**, its first electric vehicle, for \$40m at a charity auction, a record hammer price for a new car. The model [divided Ferrari fans](#) when the company unveiled it in May. Some disliked the smooth exterior penned by Sir Jony Ive, the original iPhone's designer. Investors were displeased too: the firm's share price fell by 8% on the Luce's release, but has since recovered.

Figure of the day: 17m, the projected number of people buying coverage through Obamacare exchanges by the end of this year, down from 21.8m last year. Read why the Democrats' signature health law is [faltering](#).

Will Germany's mood continue to brighten?



Photograph: DPA

Gloomy German spirits may be lifting. In July, the ZEW Indicator of Economic Sentiment, which measures investor confidence, more than doubled from June, climbing out of a slump deepened by America's war against Iran. On Tuesday the index will reveal whether investors remain upbeat.

Europe's largest economy appears to have momentum. In June new orders in manufacturing unexpectedly rose by 3.1% compared with a month earlier and exports were up nearly 1% from May. Friedrich Merz, the chancellor, offered a further boost last month, unveiling sweeping economic reforms, including €10bn (\$11bn) in tax relief for people on lower incomes. He also proposed changes to the pension system, among them a higher retirement age.

There are problems, however. The five successive heatwaves that hit Europe this summer have severely disrupted trade along the country's parched rivers. Searing temperatures could shave as much as 0.5% off Germany's GDP. And with no respite yet from Europe's record-breaking drought, the cost could rise further still.

America-Canada talks go down to the wire



Photograph: Getty Images

America and Canada have until Tuesday to reach a deal. Without an agreement, Donald Trump has vowed to apply new 50% tariffs on around \$20bn worth of Canadian goods, effective from midnight. There has been some progress, but talks are expected to go right down to the final hours. Should Mr Trump carry out his threat, it will add to Canada's woes: existing tariffs of up to 50% have already battered its automotive, aluminium and wood sectors.

A central demand from Mr Trump is for eight Canadian provinces to restock American booze on supermarket shelves, following boycotts in response to earlier levies. In return Canada wants lower tariffs on goods such as lumber and cars. Canada's protected dairy market is also a target of American negotiators. Ordinary Canadians despise [the president's bullying tactics](#). Polls suggest they are in no mood to see their leaders accommodate Mr Trump.

Democratic hopes dim in the Sunshine State



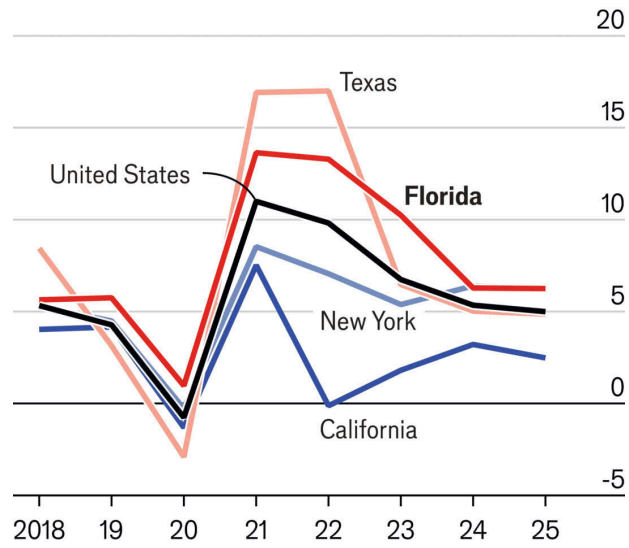
Photograph: Getty Images

On Tuesday voters in Florida will pick the Republican and Democratic candidates for governor in one of the country's final primary elections before midterms in November. Byron Donalds, a congressman, leads the Republican field. His likely opponent is David Jolly, a one-time Republican who left the party in opposition to Donald Trump. The Democrats face steep odds: the Sunshine State has not elected a governor from the party since 1994.

Ron DeSantis, the departing governor, [transformed Florida](#) over his nearly eight years in office, during which time its GDP growth has outpaced the national average and big firms such as Palantir moved there. His decision to open the state during the covid-19 pandemic attracted conservatives fleeing lockdowns in Democratic-run cities such as New York and Chicago. His “war on woke” then turned the state into a laboratory for Republican policy. Today Florida serves as the president's adoptive home, where foreign leaders come to curry favour. It was once America's quintessential swing state. Now it's MAGA-land.

Walking on sunshine

GDP, % change on a year earlier



Source: Federal Reserve Bank of St Louis

Tata's turmoil is far from over



Photograph: Getty Images

For months, Tata, an Indian conglomerate that sells everything from salt to software, has been consumed by [boardroom drama](#). The most recent twist came last week, when the board's chair, Natarajan Chandrasekaran, unexpectedly announced he would step down after his term ends in February 2027.

Mr Chandrasekaran runs Tata Sons, the holding company for the conglomerate, which is majority-owned by Tata Trusts, a collection of charitable trusts. Noel Tata, chair of Tata Trusts, clashed with Mr Chandrasekaran over whether the holding company should go public, which Mr Tata has reportedly resisted. The pair also disagreed over broader strategy and the succession plan for Mr Chandreskaran.

None of this is immediately resolved by Mr Chandreskaran's surprise announcement. Nor will Tata's annual general meeting on Tuesday offer much relief. The meeting is expected to be adjourned after one of the trusts warned it may not send a representative, blocking the board's ability to vote. Investors hoping for clarity will have to wait.

Is big tech the new big tobacco?



Photograph: Jason Henry/New York Times/Redux/Eyevine

Meta goes on trial on Tuesday, facing accusations by four American states of designing Facebook and Instagram in order to harm children. Opening arguments begin in a federal court in Oakland, California, with the lead plaintiffs—California, Colorado, Kentucky and New Jersey—alleging that Meta crafted its platforms to keep children hooked and misled the public about their safety. They are among 29 states also claiming Meta collected data from children without parental consent.

Meta faces thousands of other federal lawsuits. A judge in San Francisco recently rejected an appeal by Meta and TikTok that they were protected under Section 230 of the Communications Decency Act, clearing the path for further claims. And [earlier this year](#) courts in Los Angeles and New Mexico found Meta and Google negligent for designing platforms harmful to young people. With these latest charges, the plaintiffs are reportedly seeking almost \$200bn from the social-media giant. Meta, which says it has long supported youngsters, disputes the allegations.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Tuesday: What term, familiar from geometry, is used to describe the act of acquiring the bulk of a commodity's supply so as to drive up the price?

Monday: Which Johnny Cash song was adapted as the title of the 2005 biopic of the country singer?

The real problem is not whether machines think, but whether men do.

B.F. Skinner